AI Essay Detector and Humanizer

By: Nidhish Shah, Junfeng Li, Cole Smolinski, Stephen Hannawi

Problem Statement

With the rapid advancement of AI writing tools such as ChatGPT, Google Gemini, and Claude, it has become increasingly difficult to distinguish between human-written and AI-generated content in academic writing. By the same token, there are many benefits to using AI that allows you to flesh out your ideas, but the answers given to you feel homogenous and sound and feel like it was given to you by a robot.

Our Solution

Our solution was to create a web app that combines the ability to detect AI written content, but then also to have it be able to “Humanize” what was written by the AI by changing the wording to sound more natural.

We set out with a few goals in mind:

- Build a functional full-stack AI-powered web application
- Provide measurable AI detection results
- Implement meaningful text transformation while preserving semantic content
- Evaluate system performance using real test data

Related Work

We used several tools and research efforts to explore about AI text detection and humanization:

The GPTZero tool , which relies on measuring burstiness and perplexity, was one of the first free online tools capable of identifying whether a text was written by humans or produced through AI. Analogously, Sapling AI offers an online detection API which calculates the probability of AI-based writing.

Regarding humanization, there has been research in paraphrasing techniques with models like T5 and PEGASUS for rewriting text while retaining its meaning. The newer models like GPT-4 and LLaMA have also proven their abilities in style transfer and text rewriting.

Our project stands apart from other existing works in multiple aspects. Our approach is not confined to detection or rewriting but rather encompasses both processes in an integrated web application. Also, our work provides a quantifiable measure of the text alteration post-humanization through cosine similarity, which is not available in other existing works.

Methods

The system provides two core features:

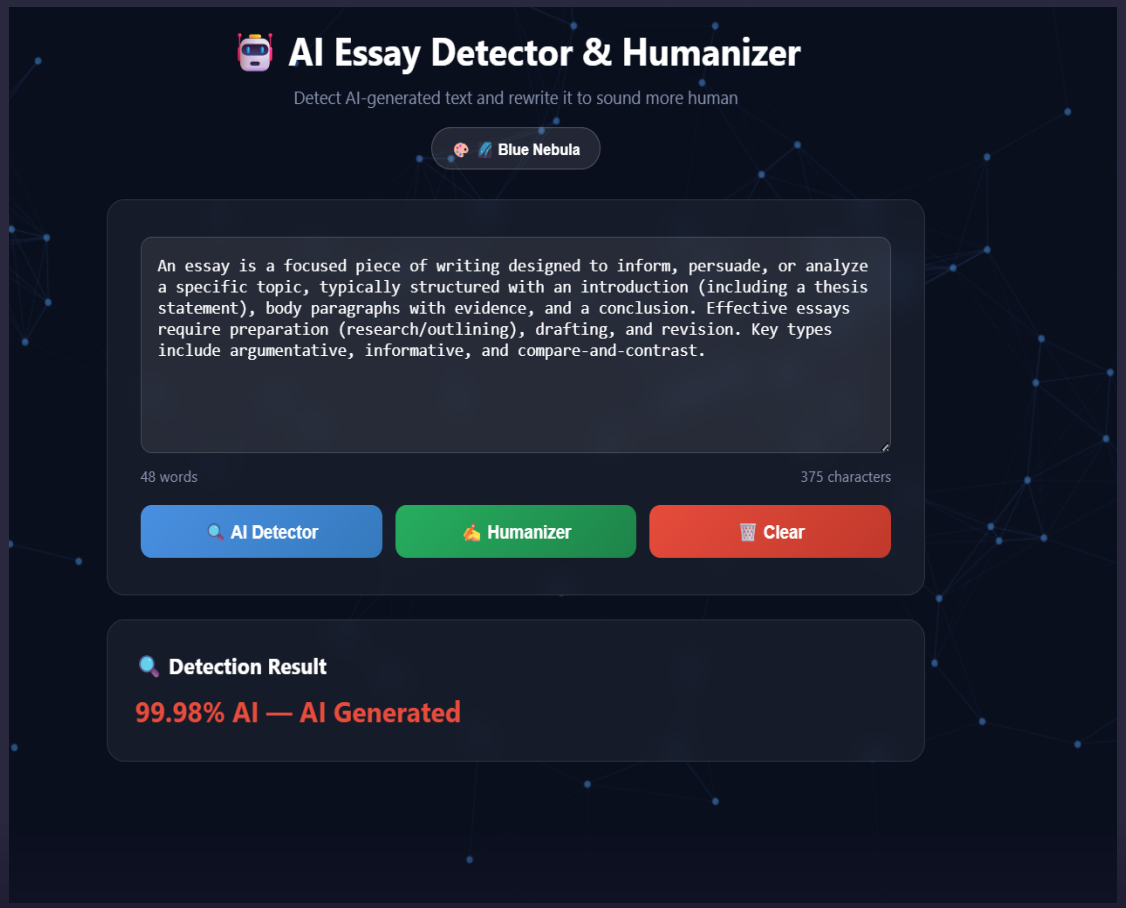
1. AI Detection

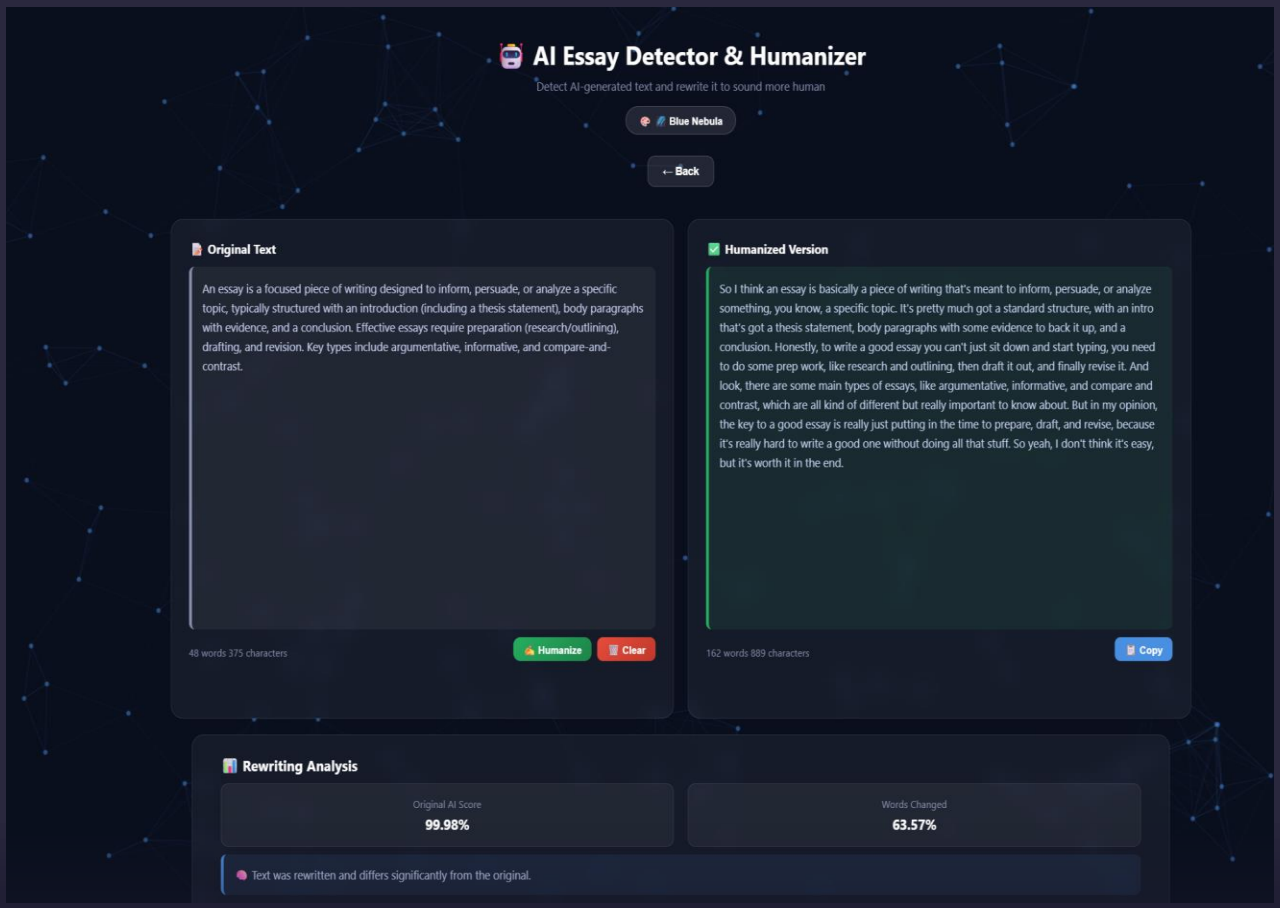
- Users paste an essay into the application
- The text is analyzed using the Sapling AI Detection API
- The system returns a score (0–100%) indicating the likelihood that the text is AI-generated

2. Humanization (Humanizer)

- The essay is sent to the Groq LLaMA 3.3 70B model
- The essay is rewritten to sound more natural and human-like while preserving the original meaning
- A rewriting analysis shows how much the wording changed compared to the original

Results and Demonstration





Broader Impact & Future Work

- Being able to detect the percentage of AI-written content in an essay is a useful tool for academic integrity and allowing others to find how much content was generated by AI. However, we also added the ability for this application to work backwards and paraphrase information to make the information in an essay sound more “human” in it’s way of speaking. This could allow for an AI to take an essay and explain it in more natural language without the loss of the important information in the essay.

- Future work is to Integrate a more powerful detection model trained on paraphrased content, Add sentence-level highlighting to show which parts of the text are most AI-like, Support file uploads for .txt and .pdf documents, Deploy the application online for broader accessibility and Expand the evaluation dataset to 500+ essays for more statistically significant results

-

Conclusion

For this project we successfully developed a web application that combines AI text detection and humanization into a single interactive tool. The detection module was able to reach 90% accuracy when run on an unlabeled dataset from the real world. The humanization module, based on the Groq LLaMA 3.3 70B model, was capable of rewriting texts in a more natural way with the number of modified words ranging between 65-75% per test sample.

Limitation: The primary drawback is that the Sapling detector always detected AI-generated text as such, which indicates that existing humanization methods are inadequate for fooling advanced detectors. Another limitation is that there are rate restrictions when using Sapling's free version.

Thank you!